



BUILDING AN EFFECTIVE TEAM

In their book *The Wisdom of Teams* (1993), Jon Katzenbach and Douglas Smith make a distinction between teams and ordinary groups of people who work together. They define a team as “a small number of people with complementary skills who are committed to a common purpose, set of performance goals, and approach for which they hold themselves mutually accountable.” They found that leaders who manage to build successful teams tend to:

- › Select members for skill and potential, not personality.
- › Focus on a few immediate tasks and goals at the beginning, to help the team to bond.
- › Set boundaries and behavioral norms.
- › Stimulate the team regularly with new information, encouraging open discussions and active problem-solving.
- › Ensure that the team spends lots of time together, both in and outside of work.

**“Don’t
find fault
– find a
remedy”**

Henry Ford,
American industrialist

